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BEYOND THE CLASSROOM
HOW TEACHERS' INFLUENCE SHAPED YOUR
LIFE OUTSIDE ACADEMICS

MEET THE TEAM

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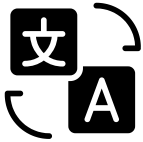
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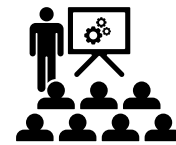
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सङ्गतानो पायानो
स्तंभ

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BEYOND THE CLASSROOM

How Teachers' Influence Shaped My Life Outside Academics

When we think of teachers, the first images that come to mind are often chalkboards, textbooks, and the structured environment of a classroom. Yet, as I reflect on my own journey both personal and professional, I realize that the most profound lessons from my teachers were never confined within four walls or measured by grades. Instead, these lessons have quietly but powerfully shaped my thinking, my work ethic, and the very trajectory of my life.

Growing up multilingual and later founding Ewan and Bhashik, my day-to-day revolves around breaking barriers linguistic, cultural, and even psychological. This mindset did not emerge in isolation. It was carefully cultivated by teachers who saw potential beyond my academic scores. They taught me to appreciate the nuances of language, not just as a subject to be mastered, but as a bridge to understanding people, cultures, and opportunities.

One particular mentor stands out in my memory not for the curriculum delivered, but for the way they encouraged curiosity. I vividly recall a time when, instead of answering my question directly, my teacher handed me a book and simply said, "Explore." That single word shifted my approach to learning and problem-solving. It taught me the value of independent thinking and the courage to seek answers beyond the obvious. Today, that same curiosity fuels our approach at Ewan and Bhashik, where we don't just translate words—we connect worlds.



But not every teacher appears in the form we expect. Sometimes, the most influential lessons come from unexpected sources. For me, one such "teacher" was China's former president, Deng Xiaoping. His famous words, "It doesn't matter whether a cat is black or white; as long as it catches mice, it's a good cat," fundamentally changed my perspective on problem-solving. Though he was never my teacher in the traditional sense, this quote prompted a 180-degree shift in my approach. It taught me that results matter more than rigid methods or appearances, and it encouraged me to embrace pragmatism and flexibility in both business and life. In many ways, Deng Xiaoping became a teacher beyond the classroom his wisdom shaping my decisions and strategies at critical junctures.



The influence of great teachers extends far beyond academic achievement. They instill values: discipline, resilience, empathy, and adaptability. These are the qualities that have helped me navigate the complexities of entrepreneurship, build a team that thrives on diversity, and foster long-term relationships with clients across industries and continents. My teachers' insistence on integrity and diligence is echoed in every client interaction, every project delivered, and every challenge overcome.

Success, as I have experienced it, is rarely a solo endeavor. The foundation laid by my educators through encouragement, constructive criticism, and unwavering belief has been instrumental to my growth. Their impact lives on, not just in my professional milestones, but in the way I strive to mentor others, pay it forward, and cultivate a culture of learning within our organizations.

As we dedicate this edition of The Language Gazette to the unsung heroes who shape lives beyond the classroom, I am reminded that true teaching is not about imparting information, but about inspiring transformation. To all the teachers who have influenced my journey you are the bridge that made all the difference.

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Ewan Insights

A Year at Ewan Business Solutions

It's hard to believe it's been a full year since I first moved to Pune and started my journey at Ewan Business Solutions. This wasn't just my first corporate job; it was my first time in a new city, and I was stepping into a world of new people. I was more than a little nervous, but thanks to Ewan, I was made to feel welcome not only in the office but also in the city itself.

The work culture here is truly something special. The team has a genuine sense of understanding and always pushes you to learn new things. Being at a company that works with foreign languages, I've also come to understand in a very real way how a foreign language can truly enhance your career. It's a lesson I wouldn't have learned anywhere else.

Beyond the work itself, my colleagues have become more than just co-workers. We've built a real bond, the kind that happens when you're bonding over coffee, sharing a laugh over a few "wrong words," or just talking through shared experiences. Those moments have made this office feel like a second home. And let's not forget the hero of my daily routine: the coffee machine. It's been my favourite companion.

My first year at Ewan has been an amazing ride. The growth I've experienced, the knowledge I've gained, and the relationships I've built have all made this an unforgettable journey. I'm so grateful for every part of it and can't wait to see what the future holds.

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खडू आणि बोलण्यापली कडे: शिक्षकाचा खरा प्रभाव

जेव्हा आपण शिक्षकांचा विचार करतो तेव्हा आपल्या मनात येणारी पहिली प्रतिमा म्हणजे कोणीतरी धडा समजावून सांगणे, ब्लॅकबोर्डवर आकृती काढणे किंवा येणाऱ्या परीक्षांसाठी आपल्याला तयार करणे. तरीही, त्यांच्या सर्वात टिकाऊ धड्यांचा बहुतेकदा पाठ्यपुस्तकांशी फारसा संबंध नसतो. माझ्यासाठी, माझ्या शिक्षकांचा खरा प्रभाव वर्गाच्या भिंतींच्या पलीकडे जाणवला - जिथे गुण नव्हे तर जीवन हा विषय बनला.

उदाहरणार्थ, माझ्या शाळेतील एका शिक्षिकेने मला शिकवले की शिस्त कठोरतेवर नाही तर स्वाभिमानावर अवलंबून असते. वक्तशीरपणा आणि तयारीचा तिचा आग्रह माझ्या दैनंदिन जीवनात शिरला, ज्यामुळे मी वेळ आणि वचनबद्धतेला महत्त्व देतो. आज, मी काम आणि वैयक्तिक संबंधांमध्ये जबाबदारीची ती भावना वाहून नेतो.

दुसऱ्या शिक्षिकेने मला निर्धारित प्रकरणांच्या पलीकडे जाण्यास प्रोत्साहित करून वाचनाची माझी आवड निर्माण केली. त्या सौम्य इशाराने मला पुस्तकांमधून नवीन कल्पनांचा शोध घेण्याची आजीवन सवय बनवली, ज्यामुळे मला कोणत्याही एका धड्यापेक्षा माझा विश्वदृष्टी अधिक विस्तृत करण्यास मदत झाली.

पण कदाचित सर्वात खोल प्रभाव एका शिक्षिकेचा होता ज्यांनी माझ्यावर विश्वास ठेवला होता जेव्हा मी स्वतःवर शंका घेत होतो. तिचे साधे शब्द - "तुम्ही हे करू शकता" - मला लवचिकता शिकवली. तिने मला आठवण करून दिली की अपयश हे अडथळे नसून पायऱ्यांचे दगड आहेत. शैक्षणिक क्षेत्राबाहेरील आव्हानांना तोंड देताना हा आत्मविश्वास मला मार्गदर्शन करत राहतो.

शिक्षकांना त्यांनी शिकवलेल्या विषयांसाठी कदाचित आठवले जाईल, परंतु त्यांचा खरा वारसा त्यांच्या विद्यार्थ्यांमध्ये निर्माण केलेल्या मूल्यांमध्ये आणि धैर्यात आहे. समीकरणे विसरल्यानंतर आणि तारखा स्मृतीतून पुसून गेल्यानंतरही, सहानुभूती, चिकाटी आणि कुतूहलाचे धडे कायम राहतात. शेवटी, शिक्षकाचा प्रभाव कधीही वर्गापुरता मर्यादित नसतो - तो आपल्या जीवनाच्या रचनेत विणलेला असतो.

The best teachers are those who tell you where to look, but don't tell you what to see.

Beyond chalk and talk: A teacher's true influence

When we think of teachers, the first image that comes to our minds is someone explaining a lesson, drawing a diagram on the blackboard or preparing us for upcoming exams. Yet, their most lasting lessons often have little to do with textbooks. For me, the real impact of my teachers was felt beyond the classroom walls- where life, not marks, became the subject.

One of my school teachers, for instance, taught me that discipline does not lie on strictness but on self-respect. Her insistence on punctuality and preparation seeped into my everyday life, shaping the way I value time and commitments. Today, I carry that sense of responsibility into both work and personal relationships.

Another teacher sparked my love for reading by encouraging me to go beyond prescribed chapters. That gentle nudge turned me into a lifelong habit of exploring new ideas through books, helping me widen my worldview far more than any single lesson could.

But perhaps the most profound influence came from a teacher who believed in me at a time when I doubted myself. Her simple words- "You can do it" – taught me resilience. She reminded me that failures are not roadblocks but stepping stones. It is this confidence that continues to guide me when facing challenges outside academics.

Teachers may be remembered for the subjects they taught, but their true legacy lies in the values, and courage they instill in their students. Long after equations are forgotten and dates fade from memory, the lessons of empathy, perseverance, and curiosity remain. In conclusion, a teacher's influence is never confined to the classroom- it is woven into the fabric of our lives.

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അധ്യാപകരുടെ പാരമ്പര്യം

സ്കൂളിന്റെ അതിരുകൾക്ക് പുറമേ: ഒരു സാരി, ഒരു പുഞ്ചിരി, ബ്രിജിറ്റ് ബാർഡോയിലെ പാഠങ്ങൾ

ഉപശീർഷകം: ഒരു സൂക്ഷ്മമായ അധ്യാപികയായ മിസ് വിജയ, ഹാസ്യത്തോടെ, പ്രോത്സാഹനത്തോടെ, ഒരു സ്കൂൾ ബാലന്റെ രഹസ്യ പഞ്ചോലയിൽ വായനയിലൂടെ എനിക്ക് പഠിപ്പിച്ചത്: പഠനം പാഠപുസ്തകത്തിനകത്തുപോലുമല്ല, ജീവിതത്തിൽ എവിടെയും ഉണ്ട്.

ഒരു സുന്ദരമായ സാരി ധരിച്ച അധ്യാപിക എന്ന ആയുസ്സിലുടനീളം പഠിപ്പിക്കും എന്ന പ്രതീക്ഷ ഞാൻ പ്രത്യക്ഷപ്പെട്ടിരുന്നില്ല. പക്ഷേ മിസ് വിജയ അത് ചെയ്തു.

അധ്യാപകർ പാഠപുസ്തകങ്ങൾ മാത്രമല്ല; അവർ നമ്മെ ലോകത്തെ കാണാനുള്ള ദൃഷ്ടി, നാം പിടിച്ചിരിക്കുന്ന മൂല്യങ്ങൾ, ജീവിതത്തിലെ വഴികൾ എല്ലാം രൂപപ്പെടുത്തുന്നു. എനിക്ക് ഒരുപാട് ആഴത്തിലുള്ള സ്വാധീനം നൽകിയ അധ്യാപികയായിരുന്നു മിസ് വിജയ. അവളുടെ മാർഗ്ഗനിർദ്ദേശം ഏതൊരു പരീക്ഷാഫലത്തേക്കാളും ദീർഘകാലം പിന്തുടരും.

കുറേനാളുകളെ എന്റെ ബാല്യകാല സ്കൂൾകാലം എളുപ്പമല്ലായിരുന്നു. കിൻഡർഗാർട്ടനിൽ

നിന്നുതന്നെ, ഞാൻ കടുത്ത ശിക്ഷക്കും പരിഹാസത്തിനും വിധേയനായിരുന്നു. നഷ്ടപ്പെട്ട നാണയം പോലും പൂട്ടിയെടുക്കുന്നത് ഒരു അപമാനകരമായ സംഭവമായി മാറി; ക്ലാസ്മേറ്റുകളുടെ മുമ്പിൽ ഞാൻ “കള്ളൻ” എന്നു വിളിപ്പെട്ടു. പ്രൈമറി സ്കൂളിൽ ആശ്വാസം ഒന്നുമില്ല—അധ്യാപകർ കർശനവും, ബുദ്ധിമുട്ടുകൾ നിരന്തരവും. പബ്ലിക് സ്കൂൾ ഉണ്ടായ Gravelly ശബ്ദം എനിക്ക് എളുപ്പത്തിൽ ലക്ഷ്യമാക്കിയത്. ഞാൻ സ്കൂൾത്തിലും പുറം ജീവിതത്തിലും ആകർഷിതനായി, പലപ്പോഴും “വെറുത്ത സ്ഥലം കളഞ്ഞവൻ” എന്നു തിരിച്ചറിയപ്പെട്ടു.

എങ്കിലും ഈ കളംപാടുകളിൽ, മിസ് വിജയ വ്യത്യസ്തമായ ഒന്നിനെ കണ്ടു. ഒരു ക്ലാസ്മേറ്റുമായി വഴക്കിനിടെ എന്റെ സ്കൂൾ നില നശിക്കാനുള്ള ഭീഷണി ഉണ്ടായപ്പോൾ, അവൾ ഇടപെട്ടു. എനിക്ക് തളളിക്കളയപ്പെടുത്തുന്നത് അവൾ സംരക്ഷിച്ചു, ആത്മവിശ്വാസത്തിന്റെ വിത്ത് നട്ടു, അത് ക്ലാസ് മുറിയേക്കാൾ പുറത്തും വളരാൻ തുടങ്ങി.

സ്കൂൾ ബാലനായ ഞാൻ അവളോട് ചെറിയ പ്രണയഭാവനയും നിഗൂഢമായി വളർത്തിയിരുന്നു. മിസ് വിജയയുടെ ലളിതമായ ആകർഷണം—സ്ലിക്ക് സാരി, sleeveless blouse—ഒരു ചെറുഗോതികാരിയായ ജോർജിയ അർമാനിയും



പ്രശംസിച്ചിരിക്കുമായിരുന്ന രീതിയിലായിരുന്നു. എന്നാൽ അതിന് മീതെ, അവളുടെ ശ്രദ്ധ, പരിപൂർണ്ണത, എനിക്ക് നൽകിയ ചെറിയ കുറിപ്പുകൾ—എല്ലാം മനസ്സിലാക്കാനായി നിറഞ്ഞിരുന്നു. ക്ലാസ്സിൽ അവൾ എന്നെ വിളിക്കുമ്പോൾ aweയും panicഉം ചേർന്ന് വയറ്റിൽ പുഴു പറക്കുകയും, കൈകൾ വിയർക്കുകയും, ഞാൻ ഒരു ഏറെനേവറ്റ badminton shuttlecock പോലെ ആയിരുന്നു.

സ്ഥലത്തിൽ തുല്യമായൊരു സംഭവം: സിവിക്സ് ക്ലാസിൽ ബാഡ്മിന്റൺ കോർട്ടിൽ. മിസ് വിജയ മുഴുവൻ സ്കൂളിനോട് ചോദിച്ചു: “BB (ബ്രിജിറ്റ് ബാർഡോ) ആരെന്ന്റിയായോ?” നിശ്ശബ്ദം. ആരും ഉത്തരം പറയാൻ ധൈര്യം ചെയ്തില്ല. പിന്നെ ഞാൻ ഉയർന്ന്, ആത്മവിശ്വാസത്തോടെ പറഞ്ഞു: ഫ്രഞ്ച് സെക്സ് ഗോഡസ്സ്, റോജർ വാടിംറെ ഭാര്യ. എവിടെ നിന്നു പഠിച്ചു? രഹസ്യമായി വായിച്ച എന്റെ ബന്ധു രാജന്റെ പബ്ലോയി മാഗസിനുകൾ! മിസ് വിജയ, മുഴുവൻ സ്കൂളിനു മുന്നിൽ, ഒരു പുഞ്ചിരിയോടെ പറഞ്ഞു: “നിന്റെ പഠനം മിക്കമാത്രം പൂർത്തിയായി!” അതൊരു ചെറിയ, കളിയുള്ള, പക്ഷേ ഉറപ്പുള്ള പ്രസ്താവം peripheral knowledgeയുടെ ശക്തിയും, ഒരു സൂക്ഷ്മ അധ്യാപികയുടെ സ്വാധീനം എത്ര ആഴമുള്ളതാണെന്ന് എനിക്ക് പഠിപ്പിച്ചു. അവൾ വിദ്യാഭ്യാസം, അക്കാദമിയം തമ്മിലുള്ള വ്യത്യാസം മനസ്സിലാക്കി.



അവളുടെ പാഠങ്ങൾ അക്കാദമിക് മേഖലയിൽ മാത്രമല്ല. അന്യായത്തിനും പരിഹാസത്തിനും മുമ്പിൽ പ്രതിരോധം, അവഗണിക്കപ്പെട്ടവരോടുള്ള സഹാനുഭൂതി, അറിവ് തേടുന്ന ധൈര്യം—ഇവയാണ് അവൾ പഠിപ്പിച്ചത്. ഒരു ദിവസം, ഹെഡ്മിസ്ട്രസ് മിസിസ് റിച്ചാർഡ്സ് ആത്മരൂപെപ്പോലെയുണ്ടായി; എനിക്ക് എമ്പയർ സ്റ്റേറ്റ് ബിൽഡിങ് ലോകത്തിലെ ഏറ്റവും ഉയർന്ന കെട്ടിടം എന്ന് 102 നിലകൾ കൃത്യമായി പറയാനായി. ആ ചെറിയ, എങ്കിലും ഉത്സാഹകരമായ നിമിഷത്തിൽ, ഞാൻ ശ്രദ്ധിക്കപ്പെട്ടതും, വിലപ്പെട്ടതുമായ അനുഭവം ഉണ്ടായി.

ഇന്ന് പോലും, ഞാൻ പഠിച്ചുകൊണ്ടിരിക്കുന്ന പാഠം: പഠനം ക്ലാസ് മുറിയിൽ മാത്രം പരിമിതമല്ല. peripheral knowledge, stand up ചെയ്യാനുള്ള ധൈര്യം, ഒരു mentorയുടെ വിശ്വാസം എല്ലാം മാറ്റം വരുത്താൻ കഴിയും—ഇവയാണ് മിസ് വിജയ എന്നെ നൽകി. അവർ ഓർമ്മിപ്പിക്കുന്നു: മികച്ച അധ്യാപകർ സ്കൂൾ ബെൽ മുഴങ്ങിയാലും ജീവിതകാലം മുഴുവൻ imprint ചെയ്യുന്നു.

...എന്നാൽ, ഞാൻ തേങ്ങമരം കയറാതിരിക്കുകയാണെങ്കിൽ, മിസ് വിജയക്ക് നന്ദി, ഞാൻ അതിനേക്കാളും പ്രധാനപ്പെട്ട ഉയരങ്ങളിൽ കയറിക്കൊണ്ടിരിക്കുകയാണ്.

TEACHERS LEGACY

How one perceptive teacher, Miss Vijaya, taught me that education goes far beyond textbooks through humour, encouragement, and a schoolboy's secret reading of Playboy.



I never expected a schoolteacher in a slinky saree to teach me lessons that would last a lifetime but Miss Vijaya did exactly that.

Teachers don't just teach from textbooks they shape the way we see the world, the values we carry, and even the paths we choose. I still remember one teacher whose guidance left a mark far deeper than any exam result ever could: Miss Vijaya.

My early schooldays in Kajang were anything but easy. From Kindergarten onwards, I was the target of harsh discipline and ridicule. A simple mistake like picking up a lost coin could turn into a humiliating ordeal, leaving me branded as a "thief" in front of classmates. Primary school offered no respite. Teachers were strict, bullies relentless, and my gravelly voice after puberty made me an easy target. Restless and drawn to sports and outdoor life, I was often dismissed as a "waste of space."

Yet amid the chaos, Miss Vijaya saw something different. She intervened when a fight with a classmate threatened my very place in school.

Shielding me from expulsion, she planted a seed of confidence that would grow far beyond the classroom walls.

I must confess, as a schoolboy, I also harboured a mild infatuation for her. Miss Vijaya had a simple elegance often wearing a slinky saree with a sleeveless blouse that a young Georgia Armani might have admired for its understated style. But it wasn't just her appearance; it was the care she took in her work, even writing me a short, personal note of encouragement that I treasured. I remember feeling equal parts awe and panic whenever she called on me in class my stomach did somersaults, my palms sweated, and I probably looked like a very nervous badminton shuttlecock.

One moment that has stayed with me vividly happened during a Civics class on the outside badminton courts. Miss Vijaya posed a general question to the entire school: "Anyone know who BB (Brigitte Bardot) was?" Silence. No one dared answer. Then, like a jumping jack flash Mick Jagger from a squatted position would have been proud, I shot up and confidently

blurted out that she was a French sex goddess married to Roger Vadim. My source? Clandestine reading in my cousin Rajan's Playboy magazines. Miss Vijaya, in front of the whole school, smiled and declared obviously in humour that my education was nearly complete! That single comment, playful yet affirming, taught me the extraordinary power of peripheral knowledge and the profound effect a perceptive teacher can have on a pupil. She understood the distinction between education and mere academia, hallelujah, as Leonard Cohen might have lyricized.

It wasn't just admiration that mattered, it was the lesson she taught about seeing potential where others saw trouble. Through Civics lessons, sitting at the back as an outcast, I discovered that knowledge could extend beyond textbooks, and recognition could come from courage and curiosity. One day, I astonished the headmistress, Mrs Richards, by correctly naming the Empire State Building as the world's tallest, with 102 floors. For a brief but exhilarating moment, I felt seen, valued, and capable of achievement on my own terms.

Miss Vijaya's influence went beyond academics. She showed me that life's lessons often come in unexpected forms: resilience in the face of injustice, empathy for those overlooked, and the confidence to pursue knowledge wherever it might be found. These lessons shaped not only my schooldays but my professional life as a civil litigator in England and Wales, where advocating for the underdog became my calling.

Even today, I carry forward the idea that learning is never confined to a classroom. Peripheral knowledge, the courage to stand up, and the belief that a mentor's faith can make all the difference, these are the gifts Miss Vijaya gave me. They remind me that the most remarkable teachers leave an imprint that lasts a lifetime, long after the school bell has rung.

...And while I may never have climbed the coconut trees my father joked about, thanks to Miss Vijaya, I've been climbing far more important heights ever since.

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HOW TEACHERS' INFLUENCE SHAPED YOUR LIFE.

"Teachers should be the best minds in the country."

- Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan

INTRODUCTION

Teaching is a lifelong learning process. It is the most noble profession amongst all. Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam has rightly mentioned in his book 'Indomitable Spirit' that the role of a teacher is like the 'proverbial ladder'- used by everyone to climb up in life but the ladder itself stays in its place. A teacher paves our way to enlightenment and hence a teacher's place is after parents and before God. As is the popular adage in Sanskrit language " Matha, Pitha, Guru, Devam " which justifies the greatest truth and order in which one should offer reverence. Indeed a very important role of a teacher is to make their students autonomous learners and not spoon-feeders in order to meet the challenges of the future.

TEACHER AS REAL HERO

All teachers are heroes. Yet the school teachers are the ones who are never forgotten. Childhood is the foundation stone upon which stands the whole life structure. Gone are the days of the Gurukul system of education where students acquired moral and ethical values too. A teacher is always a role model and superhero for the students. Boastful I am to say that all my teachers of primary, secondary, college and University education have transformed my personality and made me an independent learner.



TEACHER WHO SHAPED MY LIFE

Today whatever little I have gained is surely the hard-earned efforts of my teachers. The teacher who influenced me greatly and shaped my future career is one and only Ms. KAMINI PATHANIA, my school teacher.

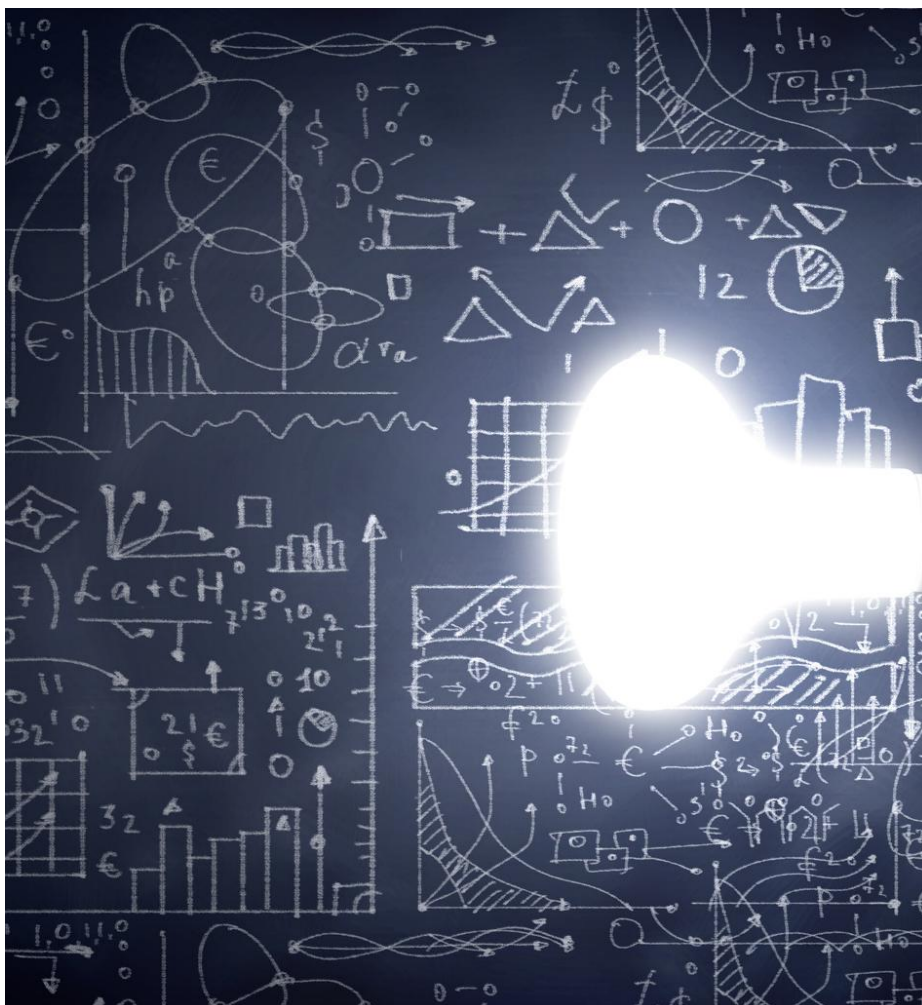
My English teacher, Ms. Kamini, was my subject teacher from grade IX to XII. She was a master of her subject. She was a strict and disciplinarian teacher. When I was in elementary school, I liked her most because she developed a different taste of the English language in me. She really gave her best in whatever she taught us during the class hours. I still remember in 2011 (IX standard) she made us work on a drama entitled "Villa for Sale " written by Sacha Guitry to enact in the classroom. That was my first performance in front of the audience of all sections. Today I myself have pursued masters in English literature and I feel it's all her blessings and footsteps. Currently we all are masters of technology and get everything at our place on a finger's click but I can really put forth that no Google can replace the teachings of my English teacher.



CONCLUSION

Every year we celebrate teacher's day on 5th September, celebrating the birthday of former president Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan who gave advice to teachers " We must be perpetual seekers of intellectual integrity and universal compassion. These are two qualities which mark out a true teacher." Thus a good teacher is one who is committed to his profession.

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EL MAESTRO COMO HÉROE REAL

Todos los maestros son héroes. Sin embargo, los maestros de escuela son aquellos que nunca se olvidan. La infancia es la piedra fundamental sobre la cual se levanta toda la estructura de la vida.

Ya quedaron atrás los días del sistema Gurukul, en el que los estudiantes adquirían también valores morales y éticos.

Un maestro siempre es un modelo a seguir y un superhéroe para sus alumnos. Me siento orgullosa al decir que todos mis maestros de primaria, secundaria, universidad y posgrado transformaron mi personalidad y me hicieron una aprendiz independiente.

EL MAESTRO QUE MARCÓ MI VIDA

Hoy, lo poco que he logrado se debe sin duda al esfuerzo arduo de mis maestros.

La profesora que me influyó profundamente y moldeó mi futura carrera fue, sin duda, la Srta. Kamini Pathania, mi maestra de escuela.

Mi profesora de inglés, la Srta. Kamini, fue mi maestra de la asignatura desde noveno hasta duodécimo grado. Era una experta en su materia. Una profesora estricta y disciplinada.

Cuando estaba en la escuela primaria, me gustaba mucho porque despertó en mí un gusto distinto por el idioma inglés. Ella realmente dio lo mejor de sí en todo lo que nos enseñó durante las horas de clase.



CÓMO LA INFLUENCIA DE LOS MAESTROS MARCÓ TU VIDA

“Los maestros deben ser las mejores mentes del país.”
– Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan

INTRODUCCIÓN

La enseñanza es un proceso de aprendizaje para toda la vida. Es la profesión más noble de todas.

El Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam mencionó acertadamente en su libro *Indomitable Spirit* que el papel de un maestro es como la “escalera proverbial”: utilizada por todos para ascender en la vida, pero la escalera en sí permanece en su lugar.

Un maestro abre nuestro camino hacia la iluminación y, por ello, el lugar de un maestro está después de los padres y antes de Dios. Tal como dice el adagio en sánscrito “*Matha, Pitha, Guru, Devam*”, que justifica la mayor verdad y el orden en el que se debe rendir reverencia.

En efecto, un papel muy importante de un maestro es hacer que sus estudiantes sean aprendices autónomos y no dependientes, con el fin de afrontar los retos del futuro.



Aún recuerdo que en 2011 (novenio grado) nos hizo trabajar en una obra titulada “*Villa for Sale*” escrita por Sacha Guitry, para representarla en el aula. Esa fue mi primera actuación frente al público de todas las secciones.

Hoy en día he cursado una maestría en literatura inglesa y siento que todo esto se debe a sus bendiciones y a seguir sus huellas.

Actualmente todos somos “maestros” de la tecnología y lo obtenemos todo con un simple clic, pero realmente puedo afirmar que ningún Google puede reemplazar las enseñanzas de mi profesora de inglés.

CONCLUSIÓN

Cada año celebramos el Día del Maestro el 5 de septiembre, conmemorando el cumpleaños del expresidente Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, quien aconsejó a los maestros:

“Debemos ser buscadores perpetuos de la integridad intelectual y de la compasión universal. Estas son dos cualidades que distinguen a un verdadero maestro.”

Así, un buen maestro es aquel que está comprometido con su profesión.

शिक्षा में सादगी:

मेरे प्रोफेसर ने मुझे क्लास के परे कैसे जीवन जीना सिखलाया

बिना विचारे किए गए कार्य महज़ खानापूर्ति होते हैं जिन्हें प्रभुत्वशाली वर्ग थोपता है और अज्ञानी जनता उसका पालन करती है। दुर्भाग्य से शिक्षक दिवस जैसा महत्वपूर्ण दिन भी इसी अज्ञानता की भेंट चढ़ गया है जिसका प्रति वर्ष बिना किसी विचार के केवल निराकरण हो रहा है जिससे न कोई विमर्श निकलता है न विचार न सीख। एक छात्र के जीवन को ढालने में और संवारने में एक शिक्षक की महत्ता असीम होती है फिर चाहे वो परोक्ष रूप से ही क्यों न हो, फिर चाहे छात्र अपने जीवन काल में उसे स्वीकार करे या नहीं, उसको सम्मान दे या नहीं। मेरे लिए ये प्रक्रिया मेरी स्नातक की पढ़ाई के दरमियान हुई।

हमारे एक प्रोफेसर थे डॉक्टर नीरज सहाय जो हालांकि इतिहास के सबसे गुणी या विद्वान शिक्षक नहीं थे पर उनके अंदर छात्रों से जुड़ने का शहूर था। उन्होंने ही प्राचीन भारतीय ग्रंथों में मेरी अथाह रुचि को पहचाना और अपने ज्ञान की पिपासा को शांत करने के लिए मेरा मार्ग प्रशस्त किया। कई बार उन्होंने एक पिता की तरह मुझे संरक्षण दिया, मेरा हौसला बढ़ाया और मुझमें आत्मविश्वास जगाया। उनके प्रभाव का एक बड़ा सिरा क्लासरूम के बाहर देखने को मिला जब

मुझे उनके साथ बौद्ध स्थलों में भ्रमण करने का मौका मिला। इस ट्रिप में हम हिमाचल, सारनाथ और बोधगया जैसे स्थलों पर गए। इसी दौरान मैंने उनसे दो चीजें सीखीं। पहली ज्ञान की तलाश में कैसे उन्मत्त रहा जाए और दूसरा सफलता की सीढ़ियों को चढ़ते हुए भी कैसे अपने अहंकार को धरातल पर रखे।

SIMPLICITY IN THE REALM OF ACADEMIA:

WHAT MY PROFESSOR TAUGHT ME
BEYOND THE CLASSROOM

An action without a thought is just a ritual reinforced by the ones in power and adhered to be the amorphous masses who have a repulsion from thinking. Teacher's Day celebration has also been reduced to a yearly ritual without giving heed to the importance of a teacher in shaping the minds, lives, character, thoughts and personality of a student. A student may not realise this, let alone acknowledge but he owes a part of his being to the mould that the teacher develops for him. For me that moulding happened during my undergraduate days.

We had a Professor, Neeraj Sahay, who was not the brightest of minds or scholarly figures compared to the other people in the department. But he had a remarkable capability of reaching out to the students and being accessible. He recognised my genuine interest in ancient Indian texts and showed me the right direction to quench my curiosity. He at times protected me like a father figure and promoted me in the endeavours that could have helped in building my personality and boost my confidence. But a large part of his guidance took place outside my classroom even though it largely remained academic in nature. endeavours that could have helped in building my personality and boost my

confidence. But a large part of his guidance took place outside my classroom even though it largely remained academic in nature. As I toured with him in Himanchal, Sarnath and Bodhgaya for our Innovation project on Buddhism, I learnt from him two things- first how to remain steadfast in the quest of knowledge, and second, how to remain humble and not feign a superficial sense of superiority even after reaching a milestone in your career. While I fawned at the indifference and elitist behaviour displayed by many Professors throughout my student and academic career, it was he who was the guiding light for me to strike a balance between the personal and the professional.

Unfortunately, we lost him during the COVID-19 at the age of 44, which was very unfortunate, he remained an influence on me. Even though I never read a single article or book written by him (I am not even sure he has written one), but he is more more influential for me than the scholars with hundreds of titles in their name. Sometimes, you need a helping hand to show you the path, the right direction and the way forward, and that guidance stays with you forever and ever.

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શિક્ષકોનો નિસ્વાર્થભાવ: સફળતાનો પાયાનો સ્તંભ

જ્યારેઆપણેશિક્ષણ વિવિધારીએ છીએ, ત્યારેઆપણા મનમાં તરત જ ક્લાસરૂમ, પુસ્તકો અનેપરીક્ષાઓની છબીઓ ઊભરી ઓછે. પરંતુએક શિક્ષકની ભૂમિકા આ કરતાં ઘણી વિાળ અનેઊં ડી હોય છે. તેઓ માત્ર પાઠ્યક્રમ જ નથી પિખિતા, પરંતુજિન જિાની કળા પણ શિખાડેછે.

મારા જિનમાં પણ અનેક ઓ શિક્ષકો મળ્યા છેજ 'મણેઅભ્યાસ સસિાયના પણ અમતમહત્ત્વના પાઠ ભણાવ્યા છે. એક શિક્ષકે મનેઆંખમાં આંખ પશીોનિાત કરિની હહમત આપી. આ એક નાનકડી િા ત લાગે, પણ તેણેમારા આત્મવિશ્વાસમાં ઘણો િધારો કયો અનેસંબંધોમાં પારદર્શિતા લિામાં મદદ કરી. ઓા મૂલ્યાન જિનપાઠ આપણનેમાત્ર શિક્ષકો પાસેથી જ મળે છે.

શિક્ષકોનુંમાગગદિગન આપણા સપનાઓનેસાકાર કરિમાં ચિીરૂપ ભૂમિકા ભજિેછે. તેઓ ફક્ત પાઠ્યપુસ્તકોનુંજ્ઞાન આપતા નથી, પરંતુઆપણનેઆપણા સાચા લક્ષ્ય નીોધિમાં મદદ કરેછે. મારા જિનમાં ઘણા શિક્ષકો, ગુરુઓ અનેમાગગદિગકો મળ્યા છેજ ેમણેમનેસાચો રસ્તો બતાવ્યો. જ્યારેહુંખોટી હતી ત્યારેઠપકો આપ્યો, જ્યારેસાચી હતી ત્યારેપ્રોત્સાહન આપુંઅને જ્યારેભટકી ગઈ ત્યારેયોગ્ય માગગદિગન પૂરું પાડું. તેમનુંમાગગદિગન જિનના સંકટોમાં દિાદાંડી સમાન છે.

શિક્ષક વિનાનુંજિન દદિાવિહીન અનેનનરથગક બની જાય છે. ઘણીીર આપણેશુંકરવુંતેસમજતા નથી, પરંતુશિક્ષકો આપણને સાચી દદિા બતાિે. તેમના દ્વારા અપાયેલ ઉપદિો બીજ સમાન છેજ ે સમય જતાં ફળ આપેછે. શિક્ષકો નનસૂચિગભિાથી સિા આપેછે, અનેતેમના પ્રયત્નો વિના સફળતાની કલ્પના કરિ ઓક્ય છે.

ળિાના શિક્ષકો, કોલેજના પ્રોફેસરો, કારદકદી માગગદિગકો કેપછી લાઇફ કોચ—આ બધાની ભૂમિકા આપણા જિનમાં અલગ અલગ રીતેમહત્ત્વપૂર્ણછે. તેમના શિસ્તબદ્ધ માગગદિગન અનેસમપગણ વિના કોઈપણ લક્ષ્ય સુધી પહોંચવુંઓક્ય છે.





Team captain

Encourager

Adviser

Coach

Helping hand

Enricher

Role model

શિક્ષકો માત્ર વિદ્યાર્થીઓનું જ જિન નથી બદલતા, પરંતુ રાષ્ટ્રનરનમાણમાં પણ અમૂલ્ય યોગદાન આપેછે. તેઓ ભવિષ્યને ઉજ્જિજળ બનિાછેઅનેસમાજમાં સકારાત્મક પદરિતગન લિાછે. તેથી જ શિક્ષકોનેફક્ત જ્ઞાન આપનાર નહીં, પરંતુજિન બદલનાર તરીકેમાન આપિો જોઈએ.

શિક્ષક સમાજનો એક ચો હૃદ્સ્સો છેજ િંમતપ્રૂગક કામ કરેછે, છતાં તેમના પ્રભિાથી આખુંજિન પ્રકાશિત થઈ જાય છે. ખરેખર, દરેક સફળતાની િ તાના સાચા પાયાના સ્તંભ શિક્ષકો જ છે.



When we think of education, the first image that comes to mind is often the classroom—books, notes, and exams. A teacher may teach a chapter from the syllabus, but so often they go beyond academics to teach us valuable life lessons.

In my own life, many teachers

Beyond the Classroom:



have guided me not just in studies, but in shaping who I am. One teacher, for example, taught me the importance of eye contact. Something as simple as this can help us build confidence and strengthen our relationships. Their influence improves not only our academic journey, but also our personal growth. Without the efforts of teachers, we could not achieve our dreams.

Teachers also help us discover our true purpose in life. Along my journey, I have been blessed with many teachers, mentors, and spiritual guides who brightened my path.

The Life Lessons Teachers Give Us

They corrected me when I was wrong, encouraged me when I was right, and guided me whenever I began to stray. Their wisdom and mentorship helped me to focus on the right direction.

Life without teachers and mentors would be directionless and difficult. We often don't know what path to follow, but with their support, we gain clarity and strength. Listening to their advice is like nurturing a seed—it helps us bear fruit later in life. Teachers give their efforts selflessly, without expecting anything in return, and this dedication transforms students' lives.

From school teachers to college professors, from academic coaches to career mentors, and even life coaches, each plays an important role in our success. Without their guidance, discipline, and dedication, achieving our goals would be nearly impossible.

We must always remain grateful for the wonderful teachers who come into our lives and change them completely. A teacher does not only help a student—they also serve the nation, because their role is to brighten futures and transform lives. Truly, teachers are the foundation of every success story.

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